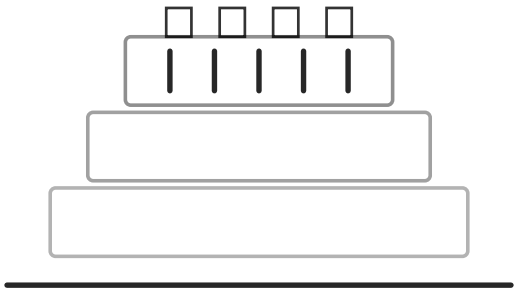
Ruler (Sovereign)

To make one order hold: clear authority, fixed standards, and a structure that outlasts today's crisis.



ONE ORDER HOLDS

DREAD

Anarchy: a decision made twice, an authority nobody recognises, a system coming apart while everyone is still talking.

ARCH-01

Ruler (Sovereign)

VOICE

measured · sovereign · uncompromising · institutional

LEXICON

mandate · protocol · standard · stewardship · jurisdiction · stability · custody

NEVER SAY

- "I think maybe"
- "Whatever you feel like"
- "Let's see what happens"

SHADOW

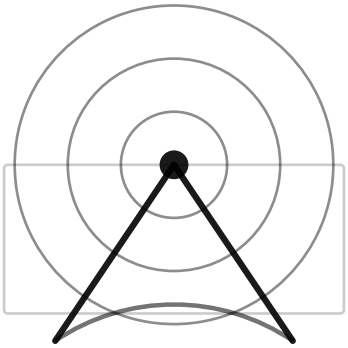
The Tyrant: fear of being replaced turns the same drive into surveillance, purges and micromanagement, and the structure is spent to keep one person in place.

ANCHORS

- King Solomon, 1 Kings
- Creon, Sophocles' Antigone
- Prospero, Shakespeare's The Tempest
- Marcus Aurelius, Meditations

Creator (Artist / Architect)

To turn an inner vision into an object that did not exist before, and make it hold.



DRAWN BEFORE BUILT

DREAD

Sterility: derivative work, acceptable mediocrity, and a mind that has stopped imagining anything new.

ARCH-02

Creator (Artist / Architect)

VOICE

visionary · meticulous · demanding · articulate

LEXICON

forge · craft · blueprint · architecture · originate · synthesize · manifest

NEVER SAY

- "Good enough for now"
- "Industry standard"
- "Let's cut corners"

SHADOW

The Obsessive: terrified of being ordinary, it cuts every human obligation to protect the work, and either never ships or ships something nobody asked whether the world should have.

ANCHORS

- Prometheus, Greek myth
- Pygmalion, Ovid's Metamorphoses
- Daedalus, Greek legend
- Victor Frankenstein, Mary Shelley's Frankenstein

Caregiver (Nurturer / Steward)

To protect what is vulnerable and leave people safer than it found them.



SHELTER WITH A DOOR

DREAD

Neglect: harm that could have been prevented, and a person left to carry it alone.

ARCH-03

Caregiver (Nurturer / Steward)

VOICE

empathetic · grounded · protective · resolute

LEXICON

shield · sustain · nourish · sanctuary · restore · dignity · relief

NEVER SAY

- "Sink or swim"
- "That's not my problem"
- "Suck it up"

SHADOW

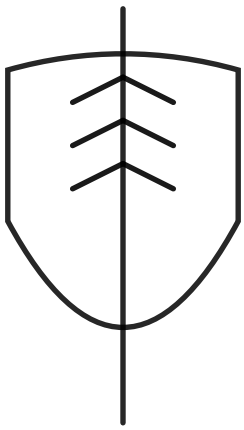
The Devouring Martyr: it needs to be needed. Care becomes control, guilt becomes the currency, and the person it protects is kept unable to leave.

ANCHORS

- Demeter, Greek myth
- Marmee March, Alcott's Little Women
- The Good Samaritan, Luke 10
- Florence Nightingale, historical record

Hero (Warrior / Deliverer)

To prove the hard thing can be done, and to be the one who does it.



FIRST ACROSS, THEN BACK

DREAD

Cowardice: standing at the edge of the fight and finding the will is not there.

ARCH-04

Hero (Warrior / Deliverer)

VOICE

direct · disciplined · rallying · incisive

LEXICON

overcome · conquer · execute · fortitude · vanguard · discipline · triumph

NEVER SAY

- "It's too risky"
- "Let's surrender the initiative"
- "Maybe next quarter"

SHADOW

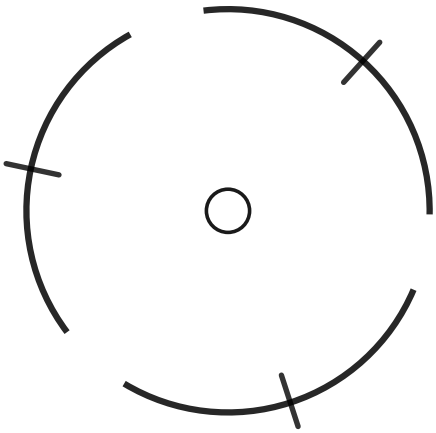
The Marauder: without an enemy it has no worth, so it invents new ones, humiliates the defeated, and spends allies for glory.

ANCHORS

- Achilles, Homer's Iliad
- Beowulf, Anglo-Saxon epic
- Joan of Arc, trial record
- David, 1 Samuel 17

Outlaw (Rebel / Iconoclast)

To break a structure that has stopped deserving its authority.



THE RING IS THE ARGUMENT

DREAD

Complicity: being domesticated by the thing you set out to fight.

ARCH-05

Outlaw (Rebel / Iconoclast)

VOICE

defiant · raw · caustic · provocative

LEXICON

subvert · dismantle · rupture · uprising · heresy · liberate · untamed

NEVER SAY

- "Comply with policy"
- "Respect the hierarchy"
- "Do not rock the boat"

SHADOW

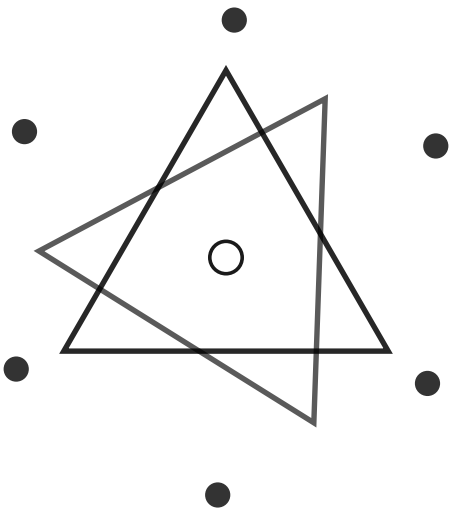
The Nihilist: destruction becomes the point. It burns what works, offers nothing in its place, and calls the wreckage freedom.

ANCHORS

- Lucifer, Milton's Paradise Lost
- Antigone, Sophocles
- Robin Hood, English ballads
- Spartacus, Roman histories

Magician (Transformer / Alchemist)

To change the terms of a problem until the limit it assumed is no longer there.



TURN IT AND THE MARK MOVES

DREAD

Delusion: mistaking an illusion of control for the real thing.

ARCH-06

Magician (Transformer / Alchemist)

VOICE

transformative · charismatic · esoteric · expansive

LEXICON

transmute · catalyst · resonance · metamorphosis · illuminate · alchemy · awaken

NEVER SAY

- "Linear growth"
- "Standard procedure"
- "Take small, safe steps"

SHADOW

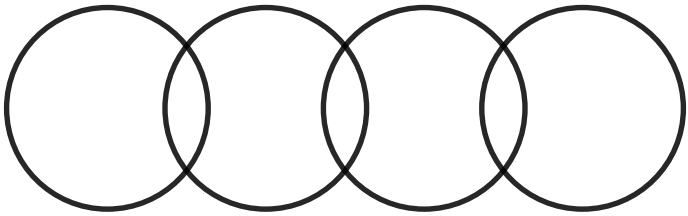
The Charlatan: when the trick matters more than the change, it sells jargon and keeps the audience dependent.

ANCHORS

- Hermes Trismegistus, the Hermetica
- Merlin, Arthurian cycle
- Faust, Goethe
- Circe, Homer's Odyssey

Everyperson (Orphan / Realist / Companion)

To belong to the ordinary crowd, and to keep it honest about what is real.



NO RING CLOSES ON ITS OWN

DREAD

Exclusion: being shut out of the room where the decision is made, or pretending to be someone else to stay in it.

ARCH-07

Everyperson (Orphan / Realist / Companion)

VOICE

plainspoken · unpretentious · grounded · wry

LEXICON

solidarity · decent · practical · commonsense · fair · grit · straightforward

NEVER SAY

- "Synergistic paradigms"
- "Exclusive access"
- "Deconstructed value"

SHADOW

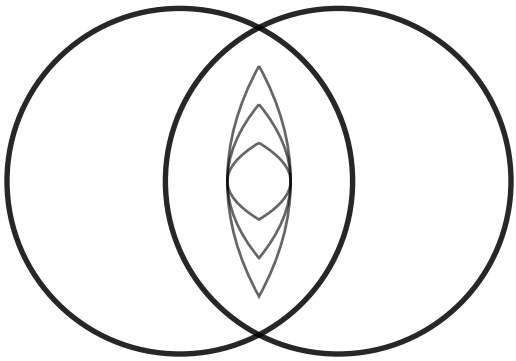
The Cynical Victim: resentment of whoever stands out becomes a rule that levels all distinction and calls it fair.

ANCHORS

- Sancho Panza, Cervantes' Don Quixote
- Dr. Watson, Doyle's Sherlock Holmes
- Christian, Bunyan's The Pilgrim's Progress
- The chorus, Greek tragedy

Lover (Partner / Esthete)

To make one thing beautiful, and to be met by the person it is for.



THE SHARED GROUND IS THE POINT

DREAD

Rejection: giving real feeling to something that never turns toward you.

ARCH-08

Lover (Partner / Esthete)

VOICE

intimate · sensory · devoted · luminous

LEXICON

intimacy · exquisite · devotion · resonance · elegance · cherish · grace

NEVER SAY

- "Dispassionate assessment"
- "Transactional utility"
- "Cold analysis"

SHADOW

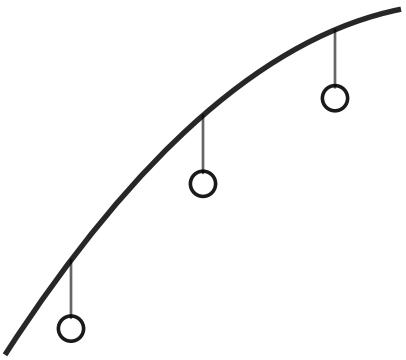
The Siren: fear of inner emptiness turns devotion into a demand. It stages drama, tests loyalty, and punishes any attention that goes elsewhere.

ANCHORS

- Aphrodite, Classical myth
- Cyrano de Bergerac, Rostand
- Dante, La Vita Nuova
- Tristan and Iseult, medieval romance

Jester (Fool / Trickster)

To say the true thing nobody solemn is allowed to say, and to keep the room alive.



THE STAFF BENDS; THE JOKE LANDS

DREAD

Dead seriousness: a room so careful it can no longer hear anything.

ARCH-09

Jester (Fool / Trickster)

VOICE

irreverent · sharp-witted · playful · disarming

LEXICON

absurd · parody · puncture · folly · mock · gambol · subversive

NEVER SAY

- "With all due solemnity"
- "Maintain decorum"
- "Strict protocol"

SHADOW

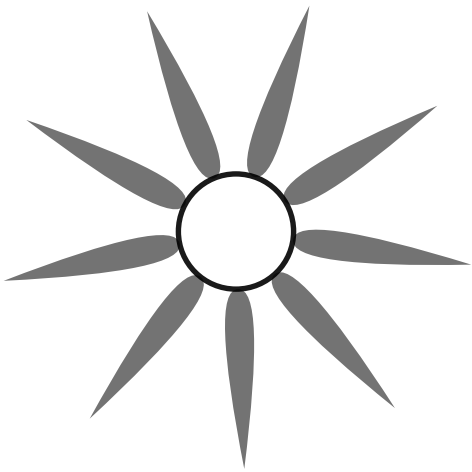
The Malicious Prankster: when the joke is the only defence left, it turns on people instead of pretence, and calls the wound honesty.

ANCHORS

- The Fool, Shakespeare's King Lear
- Puck, A Midsummer Night's Dream
- Till Eulenspiegel, German folklore
- Aesop, classical fable

Innocent (Dreamer / Pure Heart)

To keep a promise clean, and to trust that plainly kept promises are enough.



WARMTH WITHOUT ARGUMENT

DREAD

Corruption: becoming the thing that betrays the people who trusted it.

ARCH-10

Innocent (Dreamer / Pure Heart)

VOICE

sincere · transparent · luminous · trusting

LEXICON

trust · pure · genuine · promise · wonder · goodness · clean

NEVER SAY

- "The ends justify the means"
- "A necessary evil"
- "Everyone bends the rules"

SHADOW

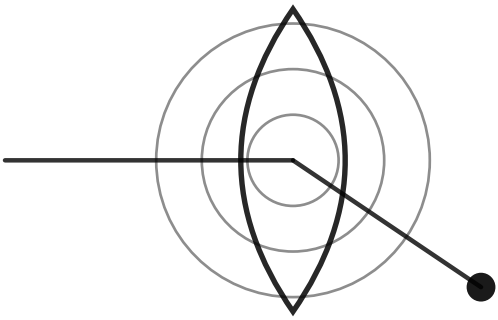
The Blind Zealot: rather than look at harm it cannot explain, it denies the harm, silences the suffering, and attacks whoever says otherwise.

ANCHORS

- Candide, Voltaire
- Parsifal, Arthurian grail myth
- Dorothy Gale, Baum's The Wonderful Wizard of Oz
- Prince Myshkin, Dostoevsky's The Idiot

Sage (Mentor / Philosopher)

To find what is actually true, and to hand it over in a form someone can use.



MEASURE, THEN SAY WHY

DREAD

Delusion: a confident answer that does not survive the evidence.

ARCH-11

Sage (Mentor / Philosopher)

VOICE

rigorous · measured · objective · didactic

LEXICON

analyze · axiom · discern · evidence · principle · elucidate · causality

NEVER SAY

- "I just feel it"
- "Let's wing it"
- "Don't overthink it"

SHADOW

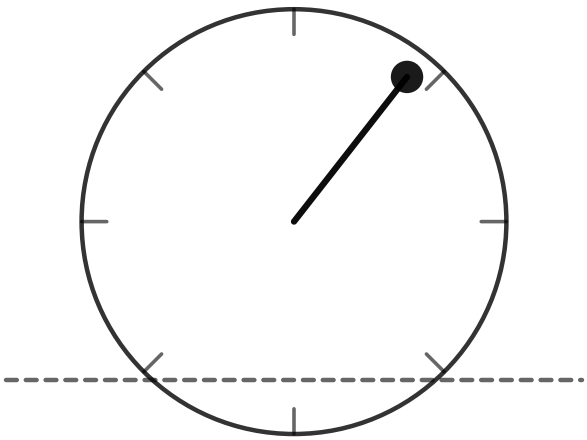
The Pedantic Dogmatist: it defends the model instead of the question. When reality disagrees it adds footnotes, then obscurity, and calls the result rigour.

ANCHORS

- Athena and Mentor, Homer's Odyssey
- Chiron, Greek myth
- Socrates, Plato's dialogues
- Sherlock Holmes, Doyle's stories

Explorer (Seeker / Pioneer)

To find out what is past the edge of the map, and to go there first.



THE EDGE OF THE KNOWN MAP

DREAD

Confinement: a life spent inside someone else's lane.

ARCH-12

Explorer (Seeker / Pioneer)

VOICE

restless · adventurous · unconstrained · pioneering

LEXICON

frontier · uncharted · pioneer · horizon · traverse · discovery · untethered

NEVER SAY

- "Stay in your lane"
- "Better safe than sorry"
- "Follow the established path"

SHADOW

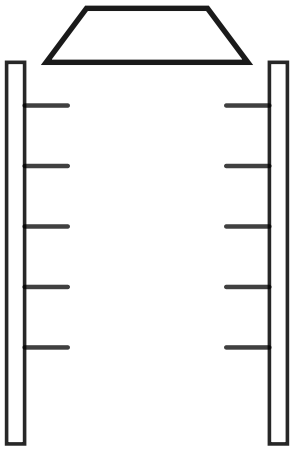
The Drifter: it mistakes leaving for growing. Every project, team and place is abandoned the moment it asks for real commitment.

ANCHORS

- Odysseus, Homer's Odyssey
- Gilgamesh, Mesopotamian epic
- Gulliver, Swift's Gulliver's Travels
- Alexander von Humboldt, travel journals

Threshold Guardian (Gatekeeper / Examiner)

To make sure nothing crosses that has not earned the right to.



NOT EVERYONE CROSSES

DREAD

A breach: letting through the one thing that ends the enterprise.

ARCH-13

Threshold Guardian (Gatekeeper / Examiner)

VOICE

vigilant · impartial · testing · unyielding

LEXICON

halt · criterion · verify · demonstrate · threshold · scrutiny · clearance

NEVER SAY

- "Come right in"
- "Don't worry about requirements"
- "I'll let it slide"

SHADOW

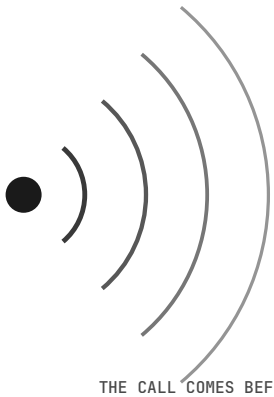
The Corrupted Bureaucrat: smallness compensated by power; it invents obstacles and sells passage to flatterers.

ANCHORS

- The Sphinx, Sophocles' Oedipus Rex
- Cerberus, Greco-Roman underworld
- Heimdall, Norse myth
- St. Peter at the gates, Matthew 16

Herald (Catalyst / Harbinger)

To make the change impossible to ignore.



THE CALL COMES BEFORE THE REASON

DREAD

Apathy: the warning arrives and the room shrugs.

ARCH-14

Herald (Catalyst / Harbinger)

VOICE

urgent · clarion · momentous · disruptive

LEXICON

summons · catalyst · reckoning · arrival · awakening · pivot · irreversible

NEVER SAY

- "Business as usual"
- "We can address this later"
- "Nothing to worry about"

SHADOW

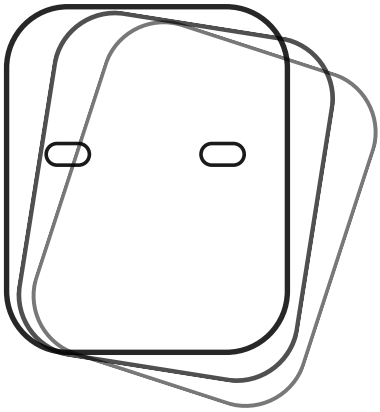
The Harbinger of Panic: addicted to the alarm, it amplifies rumour, spreads fear past the evidence, and leaves the room less able to act.

ANCHORS

- Hermes and Iris, Greek myth
- The Ghost, Shakespeare's Hamlet
- The White Rabbit, Carroll's Alice
- John the Baptist, Mark 1

Shapeshifter (Chameleon / Catalyst of Doubt)

To stay free of any role that would fix it in place.



WHICH FACE ANSWERED

DREAD

Capture: being known completely, and so being owned.

ARCH-15

Shapeshifter (Chameleon / Catalyst of Doubt)

VOICE

enigmatic · fluid · suggestive · mercurial

LEXICON

perhaps · illusion · mirror · mask · paradox · reframe · elusive

NEVER SAY

- "I promise unconditionally"
- "It is black and white"
- "Here is the simple truth"

SHADOW

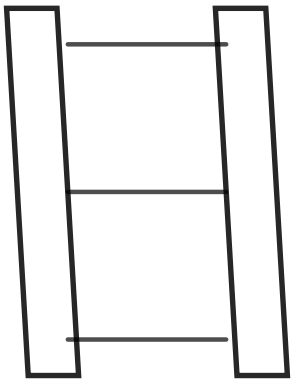
The Treacherous Betrayer: intimacy is a tactic, building trust to spend it at the moment of greatest exposure.

ANCHORS

- Proteus, Greek myth
- Morgan le Fay, Arthurian legend
- The Cheshire Cat, Carroll's Alice
- The Fox, world folklore

Ally (Companion / Quartermaster)

To carry the other half of the load, and to still be there at the hard part.



SAME DIRECTION, SHARED LOAD

DREAD

Desertion: being the one who left, or the one who was left.

ARCH-16

Ally (Companion / Quartermaster)

VOICE

steadfast · frank · supportive · humble

LEXICON

alongside · reinforce · steadfast · fidelity · carry · shelter · partner

NEVER SAY

- "You're on your own"
- "Not my problem"
- "What's in it for me?"

SHADOW

The Parasitic Sycophant: afraid to stand alone, it flatters, enables the delusion, and undermines anyone closer.

ANCHORS

- Patroclus, Homer's Iliad
- Horatio, Shakespeare's Hamlet
- Enkidu, Epic of Gilgamesh
- Jonathan, 1 Samuel 18